



Oi, jyyuuu alroight?!

CAMBRIDGE UNIVERSITY PRESS
DEPARTMENT OF LINGUISTICS LEH

Author: Chi Hin Chan
Honorary Authors: Sandra Poecshmann

Chapter 1

The basics

One of the main motivations of writing this two-page book is to document the array of fancy vocabulary spoken in the UK, necessary for navigating (surviving) the social life here (or Singapore) - if you desire one. Of course, this book would not be useful for you if you prefer the life of a *hikikomori* ¹, but sorry no refunds. I have lived in the UK for 3 years now, and have taken a long time to understand the nauced English language sufficiently. As you might have already guessed from my name (*I chinese*), I grew up in Singapore and became 200% proficient in the art of Singlish after reciting the pledge for more than 10 years of my life, *wa wayang leh*. You can only imagine the curious faces I received when I said that 'I'm damm shagged man' to my non-Singaporean (*Malaysia also can*) friends.

Now, if you are starting your life in the UK (or Singapore), I hope that you will find these translation useful for navigating the awkward conversations like I had. In the following non-exhaustive list (i.e. work in progress), I will outline some of the basic slangs in both countries. As you might have already noticed, the *italised* words refer to *Singlish* vocabulary, and the words that come after the hyphen '-' are in BBC (*don't anyhow*) English,

1. *OI!* - You alright (or, DYUU OLRIOIGHT with a pint in hand for the full experience),
2. *Hórr* (*pronouced with the positive gradient*) - Do you know what I mean (or, JEANETTE AMIN),
3. *Shag sia* - I'm knackered,
4. *Siao ah* - Shocking!
5. *Fun sia* - Oh its mad fun bruv,
6. *Jialat* - I'm not having it.
7. *Sibei Jialat* - I'm not having **ANY** of it.
8. *Stun like vegetable* - I'm shocked.
9. *You know horr* - Oh sorry, are you informed of..

When in doubt, begin your sentences with "Oh sorry". **Good luck!!**

¹A severe form of social withdrawal

Chapter 2

Becasue a single chapter isn't sufficient

1. *Auntie Kopi* - Hello you alright, how are we doing today, can I have a flat white please, thank you!
2. *Chin chai* - Whatever..
3. *Hot sia* - It's **BOILLING** INIT!
4. *Siao ah* - THAT'S CRIMINAL!
5. *Malu* - A disgrace

Chapter 3

Entries from Google response

The entries below are fetched from Google sheets.

1. *Malu* - Disgraceful!
2. *Oi* - you alright
3. *Sian leh* - I'm miserable